

SENATE No. 934

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Patricia D. Jehlen

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing the public higher education faculty advancement pilot program.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>12/2/2025</i>

SENATE No. 934

By Ms. Jehlen, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 934) of Patricia D. Jehlen for legislation to establish the public higher education faculty advancement pilot program. Higher Education.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing the public higher education faculty advancement pilot program.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 15A of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2024 Official
2 Edition, is hereby

3 amended by adding the following section:-

4 Section 45. (a) There shall be established a faculty advancement pilot program to
5 evaluate strategies for improving contingent faculty working conditions and career pathways at
6 public institutions of higher education.

7 (b) For purposes of this section, the following words shall have the following meanings:-

8 "Contingent faculty member", an instructor at a public institution of higher education
9 who: (i) teaches at least 2 courses per academic year; (ii) is compensated on a per-course basis;
10 and (iii) is not in a tenure-track position.

"Pilot institution", a public institution of higher education selected to participate in the pilot program established by this section.

"Program", the faculty advancement pilot program established pursuant to subsection (a).

(c) The board shall select 3 pilot institutions through a competitive application process, including:

(1) 1 community college;

(2) 1 state university; and

(3) 1 campus of the University of Massachusetts.

(d) Each pilot institution shall test specific reforms including:

(1) Career Advancement Framework:

(i) Creation of two advancement tiers for contingent faculty;

(ii) Clear criteria for movement between tiers;

(iii) Professional development opportunities;

(iv) Internal pathways to full-time positions.

(2) Working Conditions Improvements:

(i) Earlier course assignments when feasible;

(ii) Shared office space for student meetings;

(iii) Access to departmental resources;

- 29 (iv) Inclusion in departmental communication.
- 30 (3) Limited Benefit Testing:
- 31 (i) Pro-rated health insurance access for faculty teaching 50% or more of full-time load;
- 32 (ii) Professional development funding;
- 33 (iii) Technology access support.
- 34 (e) There shall be established a pilot program oversight committee consisting of:
- 35 (1) The commissioner of higher education or designee, who shall serve as chair;
- 36 (2) 1 representative from each pilot institution;
- 37 (3) 3 undergraduate student members, appointed by the board;
- 38 (4) 3 contingent faculty members, appointed by the board;
- 39 (5) 1 representative of the state auditor's office;
- 40 (6) 1 representative of the Public Higher Education Network of Massachusetts;
- 41 (7) 1 representative of the American Federation of Teachers;
- 42 (8) 1 representative of the Massachusetts Teachers Association;
- 43 (9) 1 member with expertise in higher education employment.
- 44 (f) The oversight committee shall:
- 45 (1) Monitor implementation costs and feasibility;

- 46 (2) Evaluate specific metrics including:
- 47 (i) Faculty retention and satisfaction;
- 48 (ii) Administrative efficiency;
- 49 (iii) Educational continuity;
- 50 (iv) Cost implications;
- 51 (v) Implementation challenges.
- 52 (3) Submit annual reports analyzing:
- 53 (i) Program effectiveness;
- 54 (ii) Scalability considerations;
- 55 (iii) Budget impacts;
- 56 (iv) Recommended modifications.
- 57 (g) Subject to appropriation, there shall be established the Faculty Advancement Pilot
- 58 Fund:
- 59 (1) Initial funding not to exceed \$2,000,000 annually;
- 60 (2) Distributed through matching grants to pilot institutions;
- 61 (3) Used specifically for:
- 62 (i) Program administration;
- 63 (ii) Direct faculty support;

64 (iii) Data collection and evaluation.

65 (h) Pilot institutions shall:

66 (1) Provide matching funds of at least 25%;

67 (2) Submit detailed expenditure reports;

68 (3) Participate in program evaluation;

69 (4) Share implementation findings.

70 SECTION 2. The board shall:

71 (a) Promulgate regulations within 180 days of passage;

72 (b) Select pilot institutions through competitive process;

73 (c) Begin implementation by July 1, 2025;

74 (d) Submit preliminary report by July 1, 2026;

75 (e) Submit final recommendations by December 31, 2027.

76 SECTION 3. This act shall take effect upon passage and shall expire on June 30, 2028,

77 unless extended by law.